



File No.: EXP202301652

RESOLUTION OF RIGHTS PROCEDURE

After carrying out the procedural actions provided for in Title VIII of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the following FACTS have been established:

FIRST: The complainant exercised the right of Access against the respondent, and their request, as stated by the complainant, did not receive the legally established response.

The complainant provides various documents related to the complaint filed with this Agency and regarding the exercise of the right exercised.

SECOND: Once the procedure established in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD was fulfilled, the complaint was admitted for processing, and the respondent entity was granted a hearing period, to present any allegations they deemed appropriate within ten working days.

The respondent entity, during the formalized procedures, has demonstrated to this Agency that it has attended to the exercised right and sent the complainant the appropriate response to their request.

LEGAL GROUNDS

I. Competence

In accordance with the powers granted to each supervisory authority by Article 58.2 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (General Data Protection Regulation, hereinafter GDPR), and as established in Articles 47, 48.1, and 64.1 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter, LOPDGDD), the Director of the Spanish Data Protection Agency is competent to initiate and resolve this procedure.

Furthermore, Article 63.2 of the LOPDGDD states: "The procedures processed by the Spanish Data Protection Agency shall be governed by the provisions of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, this organic law, the regulatory provisions issued in its development, and, as long as they do not contradict them, subsidiarily by the general rules on administrative procedures."

II. Preliminary Issues

In accordance with the provisions of Article 55 of the GDPR, the Spanish Data Protection Agency is competent to perform the functions assigned to it in Article 57, including the enforcement of the Regulation and promoting awareness among data controllers and processors regarding their obligations, as well as addressing complaints submitted by a data subject and investigating the reasons for them.

Correspondingly, Article 31 of the GDPR establishes the obligation of data controllers and processors to cooperate with the supervisory authority that requests it in the performance of its functions. In cases where they have appointed a data protection officer, Article 39 of the GDPR assigns this officer the function of cooperating with that authority.

Likewise, the internal legal framework, in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD, has provided a mechanism prior to the admission of complaints filed with the Spanish Data Protection Agency, which consists of forwarding them to the data protection officers designated by the controllers or processors, for the purposes provided in Article 37 of the aforementioned regulation, or to them when they have not appointed one, so that they can analyze these complaints and respond to them within one month. In accordance with this regulation, prior to the admission of the complaint that gives rise to this procedure, it was forwarded to the responsible entity for analysis, to respond to this Agency within one month and to demonstrate that it had provided the complainant with the appropriate response, in the event of exercising the rights regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR.

The result of this forwarding did not allow for understanding the complainant's claims to be satisfied. Consequently, on April 4, 2023, for the purposes provided in Article 64.2 of the LOPDGDD, the Director of the Spanish Data Protection Agency agreed to admit the complaint for processing. This admission agreement determines the opening of the present procedure for the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, regulated in Article

64.1 of the LOPDGDD, according to which:

“1. When the procedure refers exclusively to the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, it will be initiated by an admission agreement, which will be adopted in accordance with the provisions of the following article.

In this case, the deadline for resolving the procedure will be six months from the date on which the admission agreement was notified to the complainant. After this period, the interested party may consider their complaint to be upheld.”

It is not deemed appropriate to clarify administrative responsibilities within the framework of a sanctioning procedure, whose exceptional nature implies that, whenever possible, preference should be given to alternative mechanisms that are supported by current regulations.

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It is the exclusive competence of this Agency to assess whether there are administrative responsibilities that should be clarified in a sanctioning procedure and, consequently, the decision regarding its initiation, with no obligation to initiate a procedure in response to any request made by a third party. Such a decision must be based on the existence of elements that justify the initiation of sanctioning activity, circumstances that do not occur in the present case, considering that with the present procedure the guarantees and rights of the claimant are duly restored.

III

Rights of individuals regarding the protection of personal data

The rights of individuals regarding the protection of personal data are regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR and Articles 13 to 18 of the LOPDGDD. The rights of access, rectification, erasure, objection, the right to restriction of processing, and the right to data portability are contemplated.

The formal aspects related to the exercise of these rights are established in Articles 12 of the GDPR and 12 of the LOPDGDD.

Additionally, the provisions expressed in Recitals 59 and following of the GDPR are taken into account. In accordance with the provisions of these regulations, the data controller must establish formulas and mechanisms to facilitate the exercise of rights by the data subject, which will be free of charge (without prejudice to the provisions of Articles 12.5 and 15.3 of the GDPR), and is obliged to respond to requests made no later than one month, unless it can demonstrate that it is unable to identify the data subject, and to express its reasons in case it does not intend to comply with such request. The burden of proof regarding compliance with the obligation to respond to the request for the exercise of rights made by the affected party falls on the data controller.

The communication addressed to the data subject in connection with their request must be expressed in a concise, transparent, intelligible, and easily accessible manner, using clear and simple language.

IV

Conclusion

In the case analyzed here, the claimant exercised their right of Access regulated in Article 15 of the GDPR and Article 13 of the LOPDGDD.

After the period established in accordance with the aforementioned regulations had elapsed, their request did not receive the legally required response.

The aforementioned regulations do not allow for the request to be overlooked as if it had not been made, leaving it without the response that the data controllers are obliged to issue, even in cases where there are no data of the data subject in the entity's files or even in those cases where the requirements set forth are not met, in which case the recipient of such request is also...

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obliged to require the correction of the observed deficiencies or, where appropriate, deny the request with justification indicating the reasons why the right in question cannot be considered.

Therefore, the request made obliges the responsible party to provide an express response in all cases, using any means that justifies the receipt of the response.

In this case, however, it is noted that during the processing of the claim that gives rise to this procedure, formulated precisely due to the lack of an adequate response to the request for the exercise of rights, the responding party has provided documentation proving the communication sent to the interested party regarding the right or informing about the decision made regarding the request. This response, therefore, occurs after the established deadline has passed.

In this regard, it should be specified that the response that corresponds to be made cannot be expressed merely as part of an administrative procedure. Consequently, considering that the purpose of this procedure is to ensure that the guarantees and rights of the affected parties are duly restored, combining the information in the file with the regulations referred to in the preceding sections, it is appropriate to uphold this claim on formal grounds due to the response being issued late, without requiring additional actions by the data controller to issue a new certification regarding the attention to the right.

Having seen the cited provisions and others of general application,
the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection RESOLVES:

FIRST: TO UPHOLD on formal grounds, the claim made by A.A.A., against REDDO CREDIT, S.L., with NIF B88635487. However, the issuance of a new certification by said entity is not appropriate, as the response was issued late, without requiring additional actions by the responsible party.

SECOND: TO NOTIFY this resolution to A.A.A. and to REDDO CREDIT, S.L.

In accordance with the provisions of Article 50 of the LOPDGDD, this Resolution will be made public once it has been notified to the interested parties.

Against this resolution, which concludes the administrative process in accordance with Article 48.6 of the LOPDGDD, and in accordance with the provisions of Article 123 of the LPACAP, the interested parties may optionally file a motion for reconsideration before the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection within one month from the day following the notification of this resolution or directly file an administrative contentious appeal before the Administrative Court of the National Court, in accordance with the provisions of Article 25 and in section 5 of the fourth additional provision of Law 29/1998, of July 13, regulating the Administrative Contentious Jurisdiction, within two months from the day following the notification of this act, as provided in Article 46.1 of the aforementioned Law.

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